

PREPARE YOUR HEART

INVITATION QUESTION

Are my resources, my plans, and my opportunities truly available to the Lord?

WITNESSING STATEMENT

Christians can plan boldly because our plans belong to the Lord—and give freely because everything we have came from Him.

MEMORY VERSE

“For a wide door for effective work has opened to me, and there are many adversaries.”

— 1 Corinthians 16:9

ONE-SENTENCE TAKEAWAY

Prepare your giving, submit your plans, and walk through the doors Christ opens.

Read 1 Corinthians 16:1-9 before Sunday. Watch for the connection between stewardship, providence, opportunity, and opposition.

THE COLLECTION AND PAUL'S PLANS

1 Corinthians 16:1-9 • September 13, 2026

BIG IDEA

Gospel-shaped stewardship prepares our giving, submits our plans to the Lord, and walks through the doors He opens.

PAUL MOVES FROM RESURRECTION TRUTH TO RESURRECTION LIVING

1

GIVE AS GOD'S PEOPLE GIVE

Paul gives the same collection instruction to Corinth that he gave the churches of Galatia. Christian generosity is a shared practice of Christ's people. (v. 1)

2

GIVE REGULARLY

“On the first day of every week” each believer is to set something aside. Giving is planned into the rhythm of worship and life. (v. 2)

3

GIVE PROPORTIONATELY

Each person gives “as he may prosper.” Paul calls for thoughtful generosity according to God's provision, not identical amounts from everyone. (v. 2)

GOVERNING KINGDOM PRINCIPLE

Everything entrusted to us—money, time, opportunity, and plans—belongs under the lordship of Christ and is to be stewarded faithfully.

THE PASSAGE FLOW

1 Corinthians 16:1-9

4

GIVE INTENTIONALLY

Paul wants the money set aside beforehand so no last-minute collection has to be taken when he arrives. Prepared generosity is better than pressured generosity. (v. 2)

5

HANDLE MONEY WITH INTEGRITY

The church will approve trusted representatives, and Paul will provide letters for the gift. Kingdom stewardship includes transparency and accountability. (vv. 3-4)

6

PLAN BOLDLY—BUT UNDER PROVIDENCE

Paul has a real itinerary and hopes to spend meaningful time in Corinth, yet he says, “if the Lord permits.” Faith plans; humility remembers who rules the future. (vv. 5-7)

7

WALK THROUGH EFFECTIVE DOORS

Paul stays in Ephesus because “a wide door for effective work” has opened—even though “there are many adversaries.” Opposition does not prove the door is closed. (vv. 8-9)

PASSAGE TENSION

Open door + many adversaries. Paul does not measure God's opportunity by the absence of resistance.

FROM THE TEXT TO LIFE

GOSPEL FOCUS

We do not give to purchase grace. We give because grace has already come to us in Christ. The risen Lord turns recipients of grace into generous stewards.

KINGDOM APPLICATION

Put your resources and your calendar under Christ's rule. Prepare to give. Make wise plans. Hold those plans with an open hand. When Christ opens a useful door, do not confuse opposition with defeat.

APPLICATION SCENARIOS

WEEKLY GIVING

Instead of waiting for an emotional appeal, you decide beforehand what faithful, proportionate generosity should look like.

A REAL NEED

A ministry or believer needs help. You ask not merely, “Can I spare something?” but, “What has God entrusted to me for service?”

YOUR PLANS

You make a serious plan for work, travel, family, or ministry—and then honestly add, “if the Lord permits.”

AN OPEN DOOR

A useful opportunity comes with resistance. You test it by faithfulness and fruitfulness, not by whether it is easy.